

11 Build a good website(not just a decent one, but a GOOD one!)

The fact that we need to give out such advice in an age where everything revolves around the Internet and Google is as good as God, frankly it's absurd. But it needs to be mentioned because of the



key role a good website plays in the success of a business.

You have every reason to reach out to as many people as you can. And a website is one of the cheapest, and not to mention most efficient means by which you can accomplish that. Only,

make sure that you start the website on a healthy platform using an affordable host. It needn't be fancy, but that doesn't mean that the landing page of your site has to look like an over-sized visiting card. Creating a good website isn't all that hard these days, neither is it expensive.

12 Government Funding

The central government is showing a lot of initiative to promote entrepreneurship in the country. Take, for instance, the Startup India initiative which has cut down a lot of red-tape experienced by people trying to start a business. There are new RBI norms to give risk-taking startups a larger safety net, in case their idea doesn't fly and they happen to run into financing problems. Under a special initiative called Standup India, banks have been instructed to lend a fixed amount to SC/ST and women entrepreneurs to get their business idea off the ground.



13 Exit strategy

Go ahead, laugh all you want. We'll wait until you're done. "Thinking about exiting even before you've started, what a joke". Things can go wrong despite your best efforts. It's always great to



hope for the best and act accordingly but it's also wise to have some exit strategy in place for when things don't work the way you wanted them to. An exit strategy could be something as

simple as selling all the inventory you purchased for your business to minimise the overall loss. Or it could be something as simple as selling the business.

14 Timing

If you'll look elsewhere in this cover story you'll find a story that chronicles the reasons for the downfall of many startups in India. Among the most common reasons cited for their failures you'll find founders stating timing as one of the most important factors. Timing in the entrepreneurial context is as important as important as timing is to a joke. Screw up the timing and a joke falls flat. Similarly, if your idea is ahead of its time or



a little behind the curve it will fall flat. Say for example you were trying to start a digital game distribution application or platform. If you did it before internet speeds were up to the mark you'd most likely have failed. Or on the flipside say you were trying to establish

yet another fashion apparel startup in today's crowded market place, would your chances of success be high? If you aren't bringing anything new to the table we highly doubt it. So timing is everything. Too late or too early both will illicit lukewarm adoption from your target audience.

15 Set specific sales goals

We daresay that you'll be hard-pressed to find a single person working in a sales department without some stress-related issue. Of course, that can be said about folks from other professions as well – like teachers, lawyers, and fruit vendors but it's most applicable to sales people. For theirs is a job that perennially revolves around targets.

When you start your business, you will have sales targets. If you haven't set them already, don't waste any more time. We mean it, you can read the rest of this article after you set those



goals. Make sure that you set the targets in such a way that you can minimise the time it requires to start making profits but without alienating your employees by putting too much pressure on them. If your employees find the going tough, they will most likely quit and that will only increase the time it'll take for you to rake in the profits. **1**